ANDREW DEGAN

Game Designer & Developer

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SUMMARY

Game designer and developer who creates imaginative games with a focus on player enjoyment. Built games in Unity, Godot, and Phaser; comfortable with Aseprite, Blender, and Photoshop. Strong in gameplay systems, procedural generation, web development, and QA, with award-winning projects. Experienced project lead and collaborator focused on applying feedback to create the best possible player experience while ensuring work quality and efficiency.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz — Graduated June 2026
B.S. Computer Science: Computer Game Design — GPA 3.92/4.00 • Dean's List, Fall 2022 – Spring 2026
Led and managed team game projects • Informally tutored classmates in programming

Kyoto University — UCSC Partner Program — Mar – Aug 2025
Study abroad focused on cultural differences in game design and player experience

Hebron High School — Career Center Program — Diploma May 2022
Two years of specialized game development courses (Unity, Blender, Photoshop) and a web design and development course • Honor Roll

SKILLS

Programming: C#, C++, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, GDScript; familiar with Rust and Swift
Design: Systems & Level Design, Gameplay Mechanics, UI/UX, Prototyping, Playtesting & QA, Narrative & Sound Design, Leadership
Tools: Unity, Unreal, Godot, Phaser, Blender, Aseprite, Figma, Photoshop, Git, FMOD, Ink, Twine, Generative AI
Languages: English (fluent), Japanese (JLPT N3)

PROJECTS

Balajong — Roguelike Deck-Builder (Unity, C#) — Feb – Mar 2026
- Programmed tiles, visual effects, and procedural generation, and led playtesting, on a 4-person team; won 1st place in Gameplay and Overall among 36 UCSC teams.

Unity Tree Generator (TreeGen) — Procedural Tree Tool (Unity, C#) — Jan – Feb 2026
- Built procedural generation algorithms and a custom editor interface for customizable trees; published open-source.

Fresh Coat of Fur — 3D Animated Short (Blender) — Apr – Jul 2025
- Wrote, directed, modeled, rigged, animated, and rendered the film solo; won 1st place in a Kyoto University student vote.

Blank Slate — Branching Narrative Game (Unity, C#) — Nov – Dec 2022
- Created a solo game with 35+ endings and path data visualizations; showcased at UCSC Kresge College's parent day event.

Other Projects
- **Parallel Protocol** (Unity): dual-character puzzle prototype built in a few days. **World of Bits** (TypeScript): GPS-based web game. **Golf Quest Mini** & **Pyoko Pyoko** (Phaser, JavaScript): browser games. **Brittle Earth Project** (Ink): three-part interactive narrative. **Spellbinding Sweets** (Unity): week-long game jam cooking game; lead programmer. **Tinkorb** (Unity, C#): in-development roguelike combining Breakout and factory building.

EXPERIENCE

AI Trainer & Coding Contractor — DataAnnotation (Remote) — Aug 2026 – Present
- Train and evaluate AI models on a variety of coding projects, writing and reviewing code to assess correctness, efficiency, and instruction-following.
- Craft complex prompts and detailed written feedback that improve model reasoning and code quality.
- Identify bugs, edge cases, and flawed logic in model-generated code and document clear, actionable corrections.
- Work independently on a self-managed schedule to consistently meet quality standards and deadlines.
- Apply software development experience, including debugging, code review, and data analysis, to evaluate solutions across multiple languages and problem types.

Restaurant Host — Tricky Fish, Dallas, TX — Jul – Sep 2023
- Greeted and seated guests and coordinated with servers to keep service running smoothly during busy shifts.
- Managed waitlists and guest flow, setting accurate wait-time expectations and handling concerns calmly and professionally.

Peer Navigator — UCSC Kresge College Orientation — Jun – Aug 2023
- Welcomed and guided incoming students through orientation, answering questions and helping them settle into campus life.
- Served as a point of contact and role model for new students, building community and connecting them with campus resources.